

5 RULES FOR IMPROVING OUR VISION

* Blue denotes ppt slide

* Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Proverbs 29:18 (KJV) ***“Where there is no vision, the people perish: but he that keepeth the law, happy is he.”***

INTRO: Proverbs 29:18 is a very interesting verse indeed. This verse is sandwiched between two verses that deal with similar topics but have nothing to do with this verse. Verse 17 has to do with correcting a son and verse 19 deals with the correction of a servant.

Right in the middle of all that, the writer pens, ***“Where there is no vision, the people perish.”*** Vision is important physically, spiritually, and professionally. Today I want to talk about vision as it relates to the spiritual and professional aspect of our lives. Today, we are going to look at five rules that if followed will help us stay focused on the vision for our lives and ministries. If we follow these rules and are successful in maintaining our focus despite success, failure and fatigue, it will be alarming what we will be able to accomplish over the long

haul.

Rule # 1: 20/10 VISION CANNOT SEE ONE SECOND INTO THE FUTURE

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Vision is awesome, but it is not everything. (Man in Shane Warren's church – Born without optical nerves – Sees perfectly)

As important as vision is to us physically, spiritually and professionally, nothing can take the place of walking in the Spirit and having discernment. A person with great vision minus spiritual perception and discernment is an accident looking for a place to happen.

Remember, vision cannot bring the future into view and as a result, if we become discouraged with our “now” it blurs the anticipation of our “next”.

RULE # 2: REFUSE TO BE OFFENDED

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Offense is one of the greatest possible setbacks to a God sized vision. The Bible says that in the last days ***“Many will be offended.”*** This truth is being played out before our very eyes:

- In families...

- In churches...
- In politics...

This week I received a phone call from a friend of mine who had been offended at a preacher for years. The only person his offense had affected was himself. The preacher had long since moved on. (Move on .org) Go to Lowe's, get a ladder and get over it!!!

Offense will blur your vision and distort your perspective. Don't allow yourself the liberty to hate others. Move on .org! Go to Lowe's, get a ladder and get over it!!!

Offense is Satan's go to strategy to stop a God sized vision. He knows that only a "me" mentality can hinder a "we" mentality.

Move on .org! Go to Lowe's, get a ladder and get over it!!!

RULE #3: NEVER TOLERATE DISHONOR

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No matter how important a person is to your vision, never tolerate dishonor. There are times that we feel we must put up with some things from certain people, because of their influence

or gifting. This is ALWAYS a mistake! Such decisions tend to bite us in the most inconvenient places!

Never pay anyone to disrespect you.

RULE #4: NEVER MAKE MAJOR DECISIONS WHEN TIRED OR DISCOURAGED

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(My experience in Arkansas with a guy who told me *"It's about time for you to move on"*)

Have you ever heard this old adage? *"Never grocery shop when you are hungry."* (My experience fasting)

Never discuss vision when you are tired. Never quit your job because you had a bad day. (If I moved a mile west for every Monday I have resigned, I would be in China right now)

(Abraham, Isaac and the servants)

RULE # 5: LOOK TO THE FUTURE, NOT THE PAST

(Motorcycle school)

(Get picture of Honda Valcree Interstate – A green one if possible – Place picture on screen)

while I am talking about the motorcycle then go back to Rule # 5 slide)

Our vision of where we are going should be so clear that we have no energy left for where we have been. (Some folks go through life like Willie Nelson – Looking back Texas)

If we allow ourselves to constantly look back we can pretty much bet we are going back. We will be like a dog chasing his tail. Lot's wife looked back and was not permitted to step into her future.

The sin of Lot's wife was not:

- Rape...
- Murder...
- Adultery...
- Gossip...
- Church strife...

She looked back!!! We were genetically engineered with eyes in the front of our head, not the back of our head, because God desires for us to go forward not backward!

Luke 9:62 (KJV) “Jesus said unto him, no man, having put his hand to the plough, and looking back is fit for the kingdom of God.”

Philippians 3:13-14 (KJV) “Brethren, I count not myself to have apprehended: but this one thing I do, forgetting those things which are behind, and reaching forth unto those things which are before, 14 I press toward the mark for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus.”

Move on .org

Go to Lowe’s, get a ladder and get over it!